

1. The contagion of fear

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-14T21:18:13+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/14/the-contagion-of-fear/>

The contagion of fear Bryan Cantrill responds to the tweet by former Anthropic employee Jacob Coxon confirming that many Anthropic researchers believe AI "could kill us all by the end of the decade". Bryan shares a story of his own youthful mistakes causing unjustified panic among less technical peers, and warns against doing the same: These ghoulish claims strike brazenly at the hearth, and given the obvious importance of AI, it is unsurprising that they have leapt into the mainstream, with people asking the natural question: how would that happen? The answers always rely on hand-wavy extrapolation into the future; for example, Jacob Coxon cites "hacking critical infrastructure" and "extinction-level bioweapons" without further elaboration. But Coxon is not an expert on critical infrastructure, nor on bioweapons ? nor, for that matter, on extinction. [...] That said, we should not expect the public to understand LLMs, critical infrastructure, bioweapons, extinction biology, etc. ? that burden must lie with those making the claim. The lesson that I learned (shamefully) decades ago is that domain experts, by way of their expertise, implicitly hold the public's trust ? and we must n...

2. What blog posts influenced your thinking the most?

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-14T20:21:48+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/14/influences/>

My comment on What blog posts influenced your thinking the most? ? Lobste.rs. An early Joel Spolsky one for me was The Law of Leaky Abstractions . I read that near the start of my career and it's encouraged me to always be looking for improved understanding of the layers under where I'm working, just in case one of those abstractions leaks. A more recent one, from 2018, is Migrations: the sole scalable fix to tech debt by Will Larson. I absolutely love his idea that migrations (e.g. replacing one service with a new one, or switching database engines, or whatever) are part and parcel of software engineering and are a skill that you should invest in and get good at, not avoid or treat as special one-offs. The Engineer/Manager Pendulum by Charity Majors was hugely influential for me. I was stuck in engineering management and worried that if I switched back to being an "Individual Contributor" (ugh I hate that term) I'd damage my career. Charity gave me permission to make the switch by pointing out that many of the most successful software developers pendulum from one track to the other multiple times over their career, and doing so makes you better at both sides. Tags: joel-spolsky ,...

3. Quoting Laurie Voss

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-14T14:34:29+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/14/laurie-voss/>

The cost of writing code collapsed, and the cost of reviewing, fixing and operating it is following, and I'm assuming it gets there. What's left of making software is finding out what people actually want, defining it precisely, and making it pleasant to use. That cost is per piece of software and doesn't transfer, so as the amount of software goes to infinity, which it will because there's no ceiling on demand, that cost becomes the whole job. ? Laurie Voss , We are all Product Engineers now Tags: laurie-voss , generative-ai , agentic-engineering , ai , llms , deep-blue , careers

4. Why didn't ReadDirectoryChangesW provide a way to correlate the two sides of a rename operation?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 14 Sep 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260914-00/?p=112696>

Perhaps it wasn't necessary, or perhaps it didn't occur to them that this a problem. The post Why didn't ReadDirectoryChangesW provide a way to correlate the two sides of a rename operation? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

5. How can I remove the Close button from my window caption?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 11 Sep 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260911-00/?p=112691>

Not through normal means. The post How can I remove the Close button from my window caption? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

6. Apple's 27.0 OS Updates

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-14T19:41:41Z

Link: <https://scriptingosx.com/2026/09/apple-27-platform-updates-september-2026/>

Armin Briegel at Scripting OS X has compiled links for all the release notes for all of today's OS updates (features, developer, security). In addition to the 27.0 updates, Apple also released 26.7 updates and MacOS 15.8 Sequoia. Big day. ?

7. Dumpster Fire ? Litterbox-Inspired Extension for Firefox

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-14T14:47:43Z

Link: <https://addons.mozilla.org/en-US/firefox/addon/dumpster-fire/>

Miles Abbott: Open x.com links in a popup so you can read the one post and leave. Port of the Litterbox Safari extension. Litterbox is a cleverer name, but Dumpster Fire is funnier. ?

8. XCancel Shuts Down Again

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-14T13:24:10Z

Link: <https://xcancel.com/>

XCancel: Unfortunately, due to a new development in the ongoing legal proceedings, we are required to suspend this service again until further notice. We can't share more details. Not surprised, and not sure what to make of the 'can't share more details' part. Again, if you want to avoid visiting X but want to see the content posted there linked from other sites (and, let's admit it at this point: there's not just a lot posted on X, it is outright resurgent in popularity), install a browser extension like Litterbox (Safari) or Post Peek (Chrome). ?

9. Interpreting Pangram

Source: Armin Ronacher's Thoughts and Writings | Published: 2026-09-14T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://lucumr.pocoo.org/2026/9/14/interpreting-pangram/>

Yesterday David Sacks wrote a tweet and within a few minutes people did, what they usually do, and they asked Pangram if it was AI. And Pangram said it's entirely AI generated . To which David replied that these AI detectors are bogus . Now Pangram has a pretty low false positive rate, but if you have ever used an LLM as a writing assistant, you will have probably noticed that it claims your posts 100% AI, even though you don't feel like they are. Pangram itself is a trained model, that attempts to detect segments of text as being definitely human, definitely AI and a mixture of the two. If you want to know how it works, they published a paper . The short summary is that they are manufacturing its own training data by starting from collections of known human authored text. An LLM is then tasked to understand the text and write a fresh new text on the same topic. They also let the LLM perform partial edits on that original human text and through that they can pick up on these co-authored details. Pangram claims their model to have rates of 0.0041% false AI accusations and 0.34% missed AI text. So now that we know this I figured it might be fun to have an LLM re-create David's tweet....

10. Guessing the meaning of a number

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Mon, 14 Sep 2026 10:44:45 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/14/guessing-the-meaning-of-a-number/>

Suppose I give you an n-digit number and ask you what it represents. This seems impossible, and in theory it is impossible. But in practice it's often possible. Apps on a phone may automatically interpret a 10-digit number as a phone number or a 16-digit number as a package tracking number. And very often these interpretations are [?] The post Guessing the meaning of a number first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Esoteric HTML - ismap vs CSS

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Mon, 14 Sep 2026 11:34:53 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/09/esoteric-html-ismap-vs-css/>

The HTML specification is old and, while there is beauty in longevity, there's an inevitable build-up of boondoggles and baggage. Some elements like have sadly been consigned to the dustbin of history - but there are still vestigial attributes just waiting to trip up the unwary. If you're young, you may never have heard of Image Maps. Back in the bad-old-days, there weren't many good?

12. The expectations of privacy in driverless cars

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sun, 13 Sep 2026 11:34:13 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/09/the-expectations-of-privacy-in-driverless-cars/>

Do riders in autonomous vehicles think that they are in a private space? Here's a fascinating story from California where an robotaxi was redirected from its intended destination and, instead, delivered its misbehaving passengers to the police. The 15-year-old passengers were riding in a driverless autonomous car around San Mateo Monday afternoon. The teens drank alcohol inside the Waymo taxi?

13. AI Is Already In Dangerous Hands

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Mon, 14 Sep 2026 16:23:50 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/ai-is-already-in-dangerous-hands/>

If you liked this piece, you should subscribe to my premium newsletter, and you can subscribe on the following links: \$70 a year , \$18 a quarter , or \$7 a month . In return you get a weekly newsletter that's usually anywhere from 10,000 to 18,

14. alt.time-capsule.reopened

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-09-15T02:58:29Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17462130/usenet-rewind-archive-revival-website>

A new tool for digging into Usenet history holds much potential for researchers. But it's also a reminder that many users thought, at the time, that it was ephemeral. (They were wrong.)

15. Pluralistic: But do you use keyboard shortcuts? (14 Sep 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Mon, 14 Sep 2026 11:02:27 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/09/14/cult-taylorism/>

Today's links But do you use keyboard shortcuts?: AI people are WEIRD. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: "Changeling"; Sony Rootkit vs CD drives; Google's scumbag lobbyists; NJ's e-voting coverup; Spying sex toys; Scott Walker dark money leak; "REAMDE"; Snowden's pardon. Upcoming appearances: Budapest, Edmonton, South Bend, Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. But do you use keyboard shortcuts? (permalink) Of all the weird recurring motifs of the stories people tell me about the AI labor wars, the weirdest is when bosses demand to be reassured that their contractors and workers will absolutely use AI to get the job done. That's weird for the obvious reason that for most people "AI" is a synonym for "low quality." No one ever said "My kid's math teacher was replaced with AI" in a happy tone of voice. No one ever said, "Oh, great, they replaced their customer service department with AI chatbots!" My teenager and her friends use "That's so AI" as a shorthand for "That's l...

16. Hoe wordt de overheid weer 'van de IT'?

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Mon, 14 Sep 2026 14:45:00 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/hoe-word-je-weer-van-de-it/>

De korte versie: De Nederlandse overheid is niet (echt) van de IT?, en legt vrijwel altijd

haar oor direct of indirect te luisteren bij een door big-tech gedomineerd ecosysteem om te bepalen wat te doen. En daardoor valt de keuze vrijwel altijd weer op Amerikaanse platformen, gerund door derden, onder Amerikaans (afluister)recht. En tegenwoordig ook vol met AI (of je nou wilt of niet). Om weer grip op IT te krijgen, en een eigen en autonoom pad te kiezen, moet er een hoop veranderen.